

Anti missile lasers

In a move that will probably change the combat landscape, the US army has come up with a laser blaster to disarm missiles

Anti mosquito lasers

Scientists at Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory have developed a handheld mosquito-frying laser. But they are astrophysicists that goes to show that looking at stars is a pretty boring job

Photo techniques for *your* camera

Interested in picking up new photography techniques, but unsure about what to try out first? Here is a shortlist of what techniques to try out depending on the camera you own.



COMPACT

Compacts are maneuverable and versatile allowing for blind and "from the hip" photography.



PROSUMER

Also bridge cameras, these offer the ease of use of a compact along with the features of a DSLR.



DSLR

Investing in filters (UV/IR etc) and accessories (triggers, mounts etc) allow for a range of techniques.



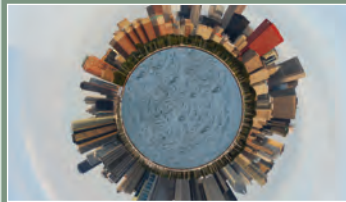
CAMERAPHONE

Composition, subject matter and timeliness can compensate for lack of quality.



SLR

There is still plenty of magic that SLRs can pull off, that digital cameras can only dream of.



PANORAMAS: Stitching the panoramas in unconventional ways, like this "planet" panorama here, is just one of the many panorama options.



FORCED PERSPECTIVE: dramatic for people appearing as smaller than or larger than common objects and structures. Alignment is paramount.



LIGHT PAINTING: Many prosumer cameras offer minutes of exposure time allowing for photographs of light trails. Photographing traffic is a common.



FOCUS STACKING: All the dew drops in this photo would not normally be in focus. Multiple exposures with different points of focus are merged together.



SPEED PHOTOGRAPHY: This technique needs a cheap trigger mechanism, that can be purchased from enthusiast or professional shops.



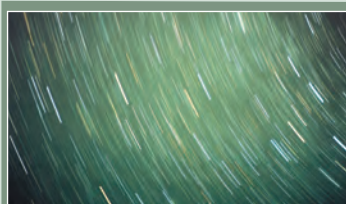
HDR: HDR imaging is similar to focus bracketing, a number of photos are taken to bring out the nuanced shades of each area of an image.



MOTION BLUR: Vehicles, pedestrians and children are all great subjects. When necessary, the phone itself can be moved to induce a controlled blur.



PANOGRAPHY: Generally, arranging images in a collage of some kind is a good idea for presentation when the images are low-res.



SKY PHOTOGRAPHY: SLRs have no limit on the shutter speed. Long exposures (minutes to hours) allow for great photos of star trails, or lightning.



BLACK AND WHITE: The graininess of the film often adds interesting textural details to the images. Getting hold of black and white film can be difficult.

The FOSS dictionary

When k or g is not a prefix in open source software, the names chosen are food for thought. We look at some of the free and open source software that live up to their names — chosen by dedicated developers who waste spend time coding for free.

Audacity: (n) possessing an exceptional amount of shamelessness, boldness, daring and even a little bit of insolence.

Beagle: (n) A short, long breed of dog, with largish drooping ears. The dogs are commonly used for tracking game while on hunts, hence the name for the software.

Blender: (n) A kitchen appliance for mixing and grinding tasty foodstuff.

Gimp: (n) Having a lot of energy and spunk.

Handbrake: (n) A lever used for keeping a vehicle in the parked state.

Kismet: (n) Another word for luck or fortune, inherently, neither good nor bad. The related meaning of destiny does not apply here.

Opera: (n) A vocal performance accompanied by music.

Putty: (n) A highly mouldable substance used to fix, plug and fix a variety of broken things.

Wink: (v) To communicate a hidden meaning by rapidly closing and opening one eyelid.